📝 QUIZ RESOURCE

Water Safety Quiz Question Bank

30 ready-to-use questions for Kahoot, Quizlet, or any quiz platform — covering all 5 lessons of the Year 7–8 Swim & Water Safety unit. Answers, difficulty ratings, and teaching notes included.

Year 7–8 HPE | 30 questions | 5 lesson topics | Kahoot / Quizlet ready | Victorian Curriculum 2.0

30	21	6	3
Total questions	Multiple choice	True / False	Image-based

12	12	6
Easy	Medium	Hard

📋 How to use this question bank

Each question includes the correct answer, distractors, difficulty rating, and a teaching note. Use them for:

- **Start-of-lesson warm-up** — 3–5 questions to activate prior knowledge
- **End-of-lesson exit quiz** — 5 questions matching that lesson's content
- **End-of-unit revision** — all 30 questions as a full Kahoot game
- **Formative check** — use True/False questions for quick show-of-hands

1 Victorian Drowning Statistics — Why It Matters

Q1–Q6 · 6 questions

Q1 Easy Multiple choice

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How many people drowned fatally in Victoria in 2024–25?

A. 32

✓ **B. 52**

C. 48

D. 67

Answer: B — 52
This was 9% above the ten-year average of 48. Source: LSV Victorian Drowning Report 2024–25 — lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy

Q2 Easy Multiple choice

What fraction of 2024–25 Victorian drowning victims were aged 15–24?

A. 1 in 10

B. 1 in 3

✓ **C. About 1 in 8**

D. 1 in 2

Answer: C — about 1 in 8 (7 of 52)
Young people (15–24) are significantly overrepresented in drowning statistics relative to their population size.

Q3 Easy True / False

In 2024–25, at least some Victorian drowning deaths occurred at patrolled beaches or public pools.

True

False

Answer: False
Zero drowning deaths occurred in Victorian public swimming pools in 2024–25, the first time since 2019–20 — a strong argument for swimming where lifeguards are present. Note that 25% of deaths still occurred in home environments.

Q4 Medium Multiple choice

Males are how many times more likely to drown than females in Victoria?

A. 2 times

B. 3 times

✓ **C. 4 times**

D. 6 times

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Answer: C — 4 times
The gender disparity reflects higher risk-taking behaviour, overconfidence in swimming ability, and social norms around not "backing down" from dares. This is a key discussion point in Lesson 1.

Q5 Medium Multiple choice

How much higher were non-fatal Victorian drowning incidents in 2024–25 compared to the 10-year average?

A. 20% above

B. 40% above

✓ **C. 60% above**

D. 80% above

Answer: C — 60% above
Non-fatal drownings are important too — each one represents a near-death experience and long-term trauma. This statistic shows the total scale of the problem is much larger than fatal figures alone suggest.

Q6 Hard Multiple choice

Life Saving Victoria reports 185 Victorian drowning deaths among people from multicultural backgrounds since 2015–16. What share of all drowning deaths is that?

A. 10%

B. 25%

✓ **C. 37%**

D. 55%

Answer: C — 37%
Country of birth was unknown in a further 22% of cases, so 37% is a lower bound. LSV also reports that 58% of fishing-related drowning deaths since 2015–16 were people from multicultural backgrounds — a sharper concentration than the overall figure suggests.

2 Beach Flags, Signals & Rip Current Survival

Q7–Q13 · 7 questions

Q7 Easy Multiple choice

What do red and yellow flags on an Australian beach mean?

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A. Dangerous — do not enter

✓ **B. Patrolled — always swim here**

C. Watercraft zone only

D. Marine life warning

Answer: B — Patrolled, always swim here
Red and yellow flags mark the patrolled swimming zone supervised by lifeguards. This is the single most important flag for swimmers to know.

Q8 Easy Multiple choice

What do black and white quartered flags indicate?

A. Swim here — it is safe

B. Dangerous conditions today

✓ **C. Surfers and watercraft only — no swimmers**

D. Offshore winds — no inflatables

Answer: C — Surfers and watercraft only
Swimmers must stay out of the black and white zone. It is designated for surfboards, bodyboards, and other watercraft.

Q9 Medium Image-based ★

🖼 *[Display image of orange windsock flag]* — What does this flag mean and what should you NOT do when it is flying?

A. Marine life present — don't swim

B. Dangerous surf — experienced swimmers only

C. No surfboards in this zone

✓ **D. Offshore winds — do not use inflatables**

Answer: D — Offshore winds, no inflatables
The orange windsock signals offshore winds. Any inflatable (lilo, ring, inflatable toy) will be carried out to sea. Many rescues involve people on inflatables who cannot swim back against an offshore wind. Use Poster 2 image for this question in Kahoot.

Q10 Medium Multiple choice

If you are caught in a rip current, what is the FIRST thing you should do?

A. Sprint directly back to shore as fast as possible

B. Dive underwater to escape the current

✓ **C. Stay calm, float, and conserve your energy**

D. Yell as loud as possible and thrash your arms

Answer: C — Stay calm and float
Panic causes swimmers to exhaust themselves fighting a current that may be moving at up to 2.5 m/s. Floating conserves energy until you can swim parallel to shore to escape.

Q11 Medium Multiple choice

To escape a rip current, you should swim in which direction?

A. Directly back toward the beach

B. Directly out to sea until the current stops

✓ **C. Parallel to the shore, then angle back to the beach**

D. Diagonally downward and then surface

Answer: C — Parallel to shore, then angle back
Rip currents are narrow channels. Swimming parallel to the shore gets you out of the channel's flow; you can then angle back in toward the beach where the waves are breaking.

Q12 Hard True / False

Rip currents are easy to spot because they appear as rough, churning white water between two calmer areas.

True

✓ **False**

Answer: False
Rip currents actually appear as CALMER, darker water between areas of breaking waves. The waves break on shallow sandbars on either side of the rip; the deeper rip channel has less wave action, making it look deceptively safe.

Q13 Hard Multiple choice

What app can you use to find the nearest patrolled beach and check patrol times in Victoria?

A. WaterSafe

B. SafeSwim

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✓ C. BeachSafe

D. SwimPatrol

Answer: C — BeachSafe
BeachSafe (beachsafe.org.au) is the free Surf Life Saving Australia app showing patrolled beaches, patrol times, current conditions, and safety alerts across Victoria.

3 Emergency Response — DRS ABCD & Rescue Skills

Q14–Q19 · 6 questions

Q14 Easy Multiple choice

In DRS ABCD, what does the 'S' stand for?

A. Safety

B. Stabilise

✓ C. Send for help (call 000)

D. Shout loudly

Answer: C — Send for help (call 000)
Calling 000 must happen as early as possible — ideally as soon as you confirm there is no response. The sooner emergency services are dispatched, the better the outcome.

Q15 Easy Multiple choice

What is the correct CPR ratio for an adult?

A. 15 compressions : 2 breaths

✓ B. 30 compressions : 2 breaths

C. 20 compressions : 1 breath

D. 10 compressions : 3 breaths

Answer: B — 30 compressions : 2 breaths
Compressions should be hard and fast at approximately 100–120 beats per minute, depressing the chest 5–6cm. Continue cycles until help arrives or the person recovers.

Q16 Easy True / False

"Throw, don't go" means you should always try to swim to someone who is drowning before attempting a throw rescue.

True

False

Answer: False
"Throw, don't go" means the OPPOSITE — always attempt a reach or throw rescue FIRST, before entering the water. Most untrained bystanders who jump in to help drown themselves, creating a second casualty.

Q17 Medium Multiple choice

According to the RLSSA throw rescue hierarchy, which option should you try LAST?

A. Throw a rope or buoyant object

B. Shout instructions from safety

C. Use a boat or vessel

✓ **D. Enter the water to swim to them**

Answer: D — Enter the water
The RLSSA hierarchy is: Talk → Reach → Throw → Row → Go (enter water). Entering the water should only happen if you are trained, never alone, and always with a flotation device.

Q18 Medium Image-based ★

🖼 *[Display image of an AED/defibrillator]* — What is this device and when should it be used?

A. A portable oxygen tank — use if someone can't breathe

B. A blood pressure monitor — use to check vital signs

✓ **C. An AED defibrillator — use after CPR if the person hasn't recovered**

D. A first aid kit scanner — use to assess injuries

Answer: C — AED defibrillator
AEDs are designed to be used by anyone — they give voice instructions. They will only deliver a shock if the heart needs it. Always ensure the casualty is out of the water before using. Know where your school's AED is located.

Q19 Hard Multiple choice

You find someone face-down and unresponsive at the edge of a pool. What is the VERY FIRST thing you do?

A. Immediately begin CPR

B. Roll them onto their back and open their airway

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C. Call 000 immediately

✓ **D. Check for danger to yourself and others**

Answer: D — Check for danger first
The very first step of DRS ABCD is Danger. Rushing in without checking for hazards (electrical equipment near water, slippery surfaces, unstable pool edge) can injure you. Then check Response, then Send for help.

4 Safe Decisions, SwimSafe Rules & Inland Waterways

Q20–Q26 · 7 questions

Q20 Easy Multiple choice

Which of these is NOT one of the five LSV SwimSafe rules?

A. Read signs

B. Swim with a friend

✓ **C. Only swim in daylight hours**

D. Signal for help

Answer: C — "Only swim in daylight hours" is NOT a SwimSafe rule
The five LSV SwimSafe rules are: Read Signs, Enter Feet First, Stay In Depth, Swim With a Friend, Signal For Help. Source: lsv.com.au

Q21 Easy True / False

Victorian alpine lakes like Lake Eildon stay warm enough for safe swimming throughout summer because they are in warm climates.

True

False

Answer: False
Alpine lakes in Victoria are fed by snowmelt and can stay below 15°C even in December and January. This is cold enough to trigger cold water shock — the involuntary gasp reflex — even on a hot day.

Q22 Medium Multiple choice

Cold water shock is dangerous because it triggers which involuntary response?

A. You fall asleep immediately

✓ **B. You gasp and inhale water**

involuntarily

C. Your arms and legs become rigid and locked

D. Your vision becomes blurred underwater

Answer: B — Involuntary gasp and inhale
Cold water shock causes an uncontrollable gasp reflex, followed by hyperventilation and rapid heart rate. If your mouth is at water level when you gasp, you can inhale water and drown within seconds, even in shallow water.

Q23 Medium Multiple choice

How many ways does alcohol specifically increase drowning risk? Which of these is NOT one of them?

A. Impairs judgment and overestimates ability

B. Slows reaction time

✓ **C. Makes you a stronger swimmer temporarily**

D. Reduces ability to regulate body temperature

Answer: C — Alcohol does NOT make you a stronger swimmer
Alcohol impairs judgment, coordination, reaction time, and thermoregulation. It creates false confidence — the exact opposite of what C suggests.

Q24 Medium True / False

Rivers in Victoria are generally safer for swimming than beaches because there are no waves or rip currents.

True

False

Answer: False
Rivers and inland waterways cause the MAJORITY of Victorian drowning deaths. They have hidden currents, cold water shock risk, submerged hazards (logs, rocks, debris), no lifeguard supervision, and conditions that change dramatically after rain.

Q25 Hard Multiple choice

According to the "1-10-1" cold water survival rule, after entering cold water you have approximately how long of useful swimming ability before muscle coordination fails?

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A. 1 minute

✓ **B. 10 minutes**

C. 30 minutes

D. 1 hour

Answer: B — 10 minutes
The 1-10-1 rule: 1 minute to control breathing after cold water immersion; 10 minutes of useful swimming ability before muscles lose coordination; up to 1 hour before hypothermia in most adults.

Q26 Hard Image-based ★

🖼 ***[Display image of a river after heavy rain — brown, fast-moving water]*** **— Which of the following is the BEST decision?**

A. It looks fast but it's still safe to swim — just stay near the edge

B. Swimming is safer than usual because the water is deeper

✓ **C. Do not enter — wait 48–72 hours for water levels to drop and debris to clear**

D. It's only dangerous for weak swimmers — strong swimmers are fine

Answer: C — Do not enter, wait 48-72 hours
After heavy rain, rivers carry submerged debris (logs, fences, rocks), move faster, and are murkier. Even experienced swimmers have drowned in post-rain conditions. The safest decision is always to wait. Source: paddle.org.au, park.vic.gov.au

5 Personal Action Plan & Community Responsibility

Q27–Q30 · 4 questions

Q27 Easy True / False

Drowning is a noisy emergency — a drowning person will always be screaming and waving their arms visibly.

True

False

Answer: False
Drowning is almost always SILENT. A drowning person cannot call for help because they cannot breathe. They may slip under quietly with little or no splash. This is why constant supervision and the buddy system are critical.

Q28 Medium Multiple choice

What is the universal signal for a swimmer in distress?

A. Wave both arms above your head and shout

✓ **B. Raise ONE arm above your head**

C. Float face-down

D. Splash repeatedly

Answer: B — Raise ONE arm
Raising one arm is the internationally recognised signal for a swimmer needing help. It conserves energy compared to waving both arms, and is clearly visible to lifeguards scanning the water.

Q29 Medium Multiple choice

What is the most important single action an individual can take to reduce their risk of drowning in Victoria?

A. Always swim with goggles so you can see underwater

B. Only swim in the morning when water is calmer

✓ **C. Always swim at patrolled locations between the flags**

D. Avoid swimming in summer when drownings peak

Answer: C — Always swim at patrolled locations
The evidence is unambiguous: zero Victorian drowning deaths occurred at patrolled locations in 2024–25. Swimming between the flags with lifeguard supervision is the single most protective action anyone can take.

Q30 Hard Multiple choice

Which organisation publishes the annual Victorian Drowning Report that is used as evidence in this unit?

A. Victoria Police

B. Parks Victoria

✓ **C. Life Saving Victoria (LSV)**

D. Surf Life Saving Australia

Answer: C — Life Saving Victoria (LSV)
LSV publishes the Victorian Drowning Report annually using State Coroner data. It is the primary

source for water safety statistics in Victorian schools. Access it at: lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy

6 Diving, Spinal Injuries & High-Risk Teenage Behaviour

Q31–Q38 · 8 questions

Q31 Easy Multiple choice

Unsafe diving accounts for approximately what percentage of all spinal cord injuries in Australia?

A. 2%

B. 5%

✓ **C. 10%**

D. 25%

Answer: C — 10%
Unsafe diving also accounts for approximately 20% of all quadriplegia cases in Australia. Source: AIHW Diving Injury Report — aihw.gov.au

Q32 Easy Multiple choice

What percentage of Australian aquatic spinal injury patients are male?

A. 65%

B. 75%

C. 85%

✓ **D. 95%**

Answer: D — 95%
This is not a coincidence — it reflects masculinity norms, peer pressure, and risk-taking behaviour patterns that are structurally driven. Source: Royal Perth Hospital spinal injury review.

Q33 Easy Multiple choice

Which age group has the HIGHEST incidence of diving-related spinal injuries in Australia?

✓ **A. 10–14 years**

B. 15–19 years

C. 20–24 years

D. 25–29 years

Answer: A — 10–14 years
This makes school-based water safety education critical at exactly the Year 7–8 level. Source: AIHW Diving Injury Report.

Q34 Medium Multiple choice

A teenage boy dives from a jetty at a location he has used safely before. He sustains a serious spinal injury. A sandbank had formed beneath the jumping spot since his last visit. This case study best illustrates which concept?

A. Cold water shock

✓ **B. False confidence from prior experience**

C. Bystander effect

D. Peer pressure

Answer: B — False confidence from prior experience
This describes the Bawley Beach jetty incident (NSW 2024). Prior safety at a location does not guarantee current safety — water depth changes constantly due to tidal action, sediment, and seasonal variation.

Q35 Medium Multiple choice

Which of the following BEST explains why cervical spine injuries from diving often result in permanent quadriplegia rather than temporary paralysis?

A. The force of impact is always fatal

B. Cold water worsens spinal injuries

✓ **C. The spinal cord tissue cannot regenerate after being severed or severely compressed**

D. Quadriplegia is only caused by diving — not other injuries

Answer: C
Unlike many body tissues, spinal cord nerve tissue (neurons) cannot regenerate after being severed or severely compressed. Approximately two-thirds of Australian aquatic spinal injury patients suffer permanent disability.

Q36 Medium True / False

True or False: "If the water is clear, it is safe to dive because you can see the bottom is deep enough."

A. True — clear water means deep water

✓ **B. False — water clarity is unrelated**

to depth

Answer: B — False
Water clarity tells you nothing about depth. Dangerously shallow water can be crystal clear. The only safe approach is to enter feet-first and physically check depth before diving.

Q37 Hard Short answer

Royal Life Saving Australia states that more people drown in inland waterways than any other location in Australia. Identify THREE specific factors that make inland waterways more dangerous than patrolled beaches, and for each factor explain the specific mechanism that increases risk.

Model answer:
Any three of: (1) **Depth changes constantly** — drought, flooding, sediment and dam releases alter depth unpredictably, creating hidden shallow zones; (2) **Poor visibility** — submerged rocks, logs, debris invisible beneath turbid water; (3) **Cold water shock** — triggers gasping reflex and muscle failure even in hot weather; (4) **Remote rescue delay** — limited phone reception, no lifeguards, and difficult road access extend emergency response time, worsening neurological outcomes; (5) **Alcohol and group risk-taking** — common combination of alcohol, males, and peer pressure at river/dam locations multiplies risk.

Q38 Hard Analysis

The data shows 95% of aquatic spinal injury patients are male. A student argues: "This is because males are naturally more reckless than females." Using the social determinants framework, explain why this is an insufficient explanation and propose a more complete structural account.

Model answer:
"Naturally more reckless" implies an innate biological difference, but the social determinants framework shows risk-taking is largely socially constructed. Masculinity norms — cultural expectations that males should accept dares, not show fear, and demonstrate courage through physical risk — drive the behaviour. These norms are reinforced through peer groups, media, and social reward systems. A structural account would note: (1) males are socialised from childhood to suppress fear responses; (2) peer pressure operates differently for males in group settings near water; (3) the same behaviour (jumping from a bridge) is praised for males and discouraged for females. Effective prevention must address the social norms, not just inform individuals about the risk.

Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · HPE · Year 7–8 · Quiz Question Bank
All 30 questions aligned to unit content and LSV/RLSSA source data

Life Saving Victoria: lsv.com.au
BeachSafe: beachsafe.org.au
RLSSA: royallifesaving.com.au

Interleaved Retrieval Set — Years 7–8

IL1–IL12 · 12 questions · mixed topics

Why this set is different. Every other section of this bank groups questions by lesson. That is useful while a topic is being taught and close to useless afterwards, because the student always knows which knowledge the question wants — the hardest part of the job is done for them before they start. This set mixes topics deliberately and in no stated order, so the student has to work out *which* knowledge applies before retrieving it. That decision is the skill that transfers to a real waterway.

How to use it. After the unit, not during. Do not tell students which topic each question comes from, and do not reorder them into topic groups — that undoes the whole point. Expect scores to drop against the blocked sections; that drop is the measure of how much of their earlier confidence came from context rather than knowledge. VTLM 2.0: *Vary practice*, Practice 2 (interleaving) and *Revisit and review*.

IL1 · Medium · Discrimination · COLD WATER VS RIPS

You are at a river in October. Someone jumps in and immediately starts gasping and breathing very fast, and cannot seem to control it. What is happening?

A. They are panicking and need to be told to calm down

✓ **B. Cold water shock — an involuntary gasp and hyperventilation**

C. They are caught in a rip current

D. Secondary drowning

Answer: B — Cold water shock, in the first minute of immersion. It takes away breath control, which is why it drowns people who can swim. Telling them to calm down does not restore the reflex — getting them out or onto something that floats does.

IL2 · Easy · Recall

What do the red and yellow flags mark?

A. The edge of the patrolled area, beyond which you should not swim

B. A dangerous area to avoid

✓ **C. The area patrolled by lifesavers, where you should swim**

D. A surfboard-only zone

Answer: C — They mark the supervised swimming area. Note the trap in option A — the flags are not a boundary warning you away, they mark where to go.

IL3 Hard Discrimination IDENTIFY THEN RESPOND

A swimmer 20 m offshore is being carried steadily away from the beach but is not panicking. The water there looks darker and flatter than the water either side. What should they be told to do?

A. Swim straight back to the beach as hard as they can

✓ **B. Float, signal, and swim parallel to the beach once calm**

C. Dive under the current and swim beneath it

D. Start CPR training breathing

Answer: B — This is a rip, identified by the darker and flatter water. Option A is the instinct that exhausts people. The question requires you to recognise the hazard first and then select the response — which is the order it happens in real life.

IL4 Medium Recall

What does the 'S' in DRS ABCD stand for?

A. Signal

✓ **B. Send for help**

C. Safety

D. Stabilise

Answer: B — Send for help — call 000. Students frequently answer 'Safety', confusing it with the 'D' for Danger that comes first.

IL5 Hard Discrimination

Which of these is the strongest reason not to swim out to someone in trouble, even if you are a strong swimmer?

A. You might get cold

B. You could lose your place in the queue for help

✓ **C. A person in difficulty will grab and push down on whatever reaches them**

D. It is against the law in Victoria

Answer: C — The physical behaviour of a drowning person is what makes swim rescues dangerous, independently of how well you swim. This is why the throw rescue exists.

IL6 Medium Recall

In 2024–25, roughly what share of Victorian drowning deaths happened in home environments?

A. None

B. About 5%

✓ **C. About 25%**

D. More than half

Answer: C — About a quarter — pools, bathtubs and dams at home. This is the figure that stops 'swim between the flags' being a complete answer to drowning prevention.

IL7 Hard Discrimination SEQUENCE UNDER PRESSURE

A person is face-down and motionless in a backyard pool. You are alone. What is your first action?

A. Begin chest compressions

✓ **B. Check that it is safe for you to approach**

C. Pull them out of the water immediately

D. Call 000 and wait

Answer: B — Danger, always first — the D of DRS ABCD. The pressure of the scenario pushes people toward compressions or retrieval. The sequence exists precisely so that pressure does not decide.

IL8 Easy Recall

What does drowning usually look like from a distance?

A. Shouting and waving both arms

✓ **B. Silent, upright, mouth near the water line**

C. Splashing violently for several minutes

D. Swimming slowly towards shore

Answer: B — Silent and brief — often 20 to 60 seconds. The film version in option A is why bystanders miss it happening metres away.

IL9 Hard Discrimination MECHANISM VS CORRELATION

Two statements about alcohol and water. Which one describes a *mechanism* rather than just a correlation?

A. People who drown have often been drinking

✓ **B. Alcohol slows reaction time and reduces the ability to hold your breath**

C. Drinking is common at Victorian beaches and rivers in summer

D. Most drowning deaths involving alcohol are male

Answer: B — Only B says *how* alcohol raises risk. The others are associations. Being able to tell these apart is the difference between repeating a statistic and understanding it.

IL10 Medium Recall

Why is a boat carrying two life jackets under the seat not the same as being protected by them?

A. Life jackets expire after two years

✓ **B. A jacket only works if it is worn and correctly fastened**

C. Two is never enough for any boat

D. They must be inspected annually by law

Answer: B — Carrying satisfies the law; wearing is what keeps you afloat when you go in unexpectedly — and going in unexpectedly is the whole scenario.

IL11 Hard Discrimination TRANSFER TO INLAND

Which of these situations most needs the *hazard-reading* skills from the beach lesson, applied somewhere with no flags?

A. Swimming laps at the local pool

✓ **B. Jumping from a rock into a river bend you have used before**

C. Walking on a patrolled beach

D. Watching a surf competition

Answer: B — Transfer is the point. The river bend looks familiar, which is exactly the false confidence problem — depth changes with sand and water movement, and there is no patrol to read it for you.

IL12 Medium Recall

The flags are still in the sand at 7 pm but the lifesavers have gone. Is the beach patrolled?

A. Yes, the flags mean it is patrolled

✓ **B. No — patrolled describes the hours, not the place**

C. Yes, until the flags are removed

D. Only if there is a sign saying so

Answer: B — 'Patrolled' is a property of the time, not of the location. The flags left standing are one of the most common misreadings in the unit.

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